

Permit Fee Calculator — Results

Permit Number: CLR-2026-0142

Municipality: Palm Beach County Building Division

Construction Value: \$4,125,000

Private Provider on File: Yes

Fee Line Item	Standard Fee	Correct Fee (w/ Provider)	Reduction Applied
Building Permit Fee	\$22,000.00	\$18,700.00	15% (provider)
Plan Review Fee	\$6,000.00	\$5,100.00	15% (provider)
Technology Surcharge (statutory)	\$1,500.00	\$1,500.00	None
DBPR / Building Code Fund Fee (statutory)	\$500.00	\$500.00	None
TOTAL	\$30,000.00	\$25,800.00	

Calculated Results

Expected County Fee (municipality's stated private-provider rate: 15%)	\$25,800.00
Total Charged on Invoice	\$30,000.00
Discrepancy (Overcharged)	\$4,200.00

Under Florida Statute §553.791(2)(b), when a licensed private provider performs plan review and/or inspections in lieu of the local building department, the municipality is required to reduce its plan review and inspection-related fees to reflect the cost it did not incur. Statutory pass-through surcharges (e.g., DBPR/Building Code fund fees, technology surcharges) are unaffected because the municipality still incurs and remits those regardless of who performs the review.

Note on the reduction percentage: F.S. §553.791(2)(b) itself does not set a flat statewide percentage — it requires the fee to reflect the municipality's actual cost savings, and the specific rate is set by each municipality's own fee ordinance. 15% is used here as a realistic placeholder. For example, the City of Boca Raton's published fee schedule sets its standard Building Permit fee at 1.60% of valuation, with a private-provider-inspection carve-out of 1.45% (roughly a 9% reduction on that line) — a different number and structure than a neighboring city might use. In production, the calculator should look up and quote the target municipality's actual fee-schedule or ordinance language for the permit's jurisdiction, rather than applying one fixed percentage across all cities.

Meridian Permit Solutions, LLC

Permit Expediting & Private Provider Compliance

permits@meridianpermits.com | (561) 555-0148

July 16, 2026

Palm Beach County Building Division

Permit Coordinator

2300 N Jog Rd, West Palm Beach, FL 33411

permits@pbcgov.org

RE: Fee Dispute — Permit No. CLR-2026-0142 | 4521 Ocean Ridge Way, West Palm Beach, FL 33411

Dear Permit Coordinator,

Meridian Permit Solutions, LLC ("Meridian") represents the permit holder of record for the above-referenced project. We are writing to formally contest the fee assessment issued on this permit, which reflects 100% of the standard municipal fee schedule despite the project's use of a licensed private provider for plan review and inspections.

The invoice as issued charges \$30,000.00 in total municipal fees. Based on Palm Beach County's published private-provider fee reduction of 15% and the construction value of \$4,125,000, the correct fee is \$25,800.00. This is a discrepancy of \$4,200.00.

Legal Basis for This Dispute

Florida Statute Section 553.791(2)(b) provides that when a permit applicant uses a licensed private provider in lieu of the local building department for plan review and/or required inspections, the local jurisdiction must reduce its permit fees accordingly, because the jurisdiction is not incurring the cost of performing that work itself. The specific reduction percentage is established by the jurisdiction's own fee ordinance; here, that ordinance sets the private-provider reduction at 15% of the applicable Building Permit and Plan Review line items. The statute permits the local jurisdiction to retain only a reasonable administrative fee, which must be based on the actual cost incurred for clerical and supervisory assistance, and any statutory pass-through fees that apply regardless of who performs the review.

The current invoice applies no such reduction to the Building Permit Fee or the Plan Review Fee, both of which correspond directly to work performed by the private provider rather than County staff. Only the statutory pass-through fees are appropriately unaffected by the private-provider designation.

Requested Action

Meridian respectfully requests that the Building Division:

1. Revise the invoice for Permit No. CLR-2026-0142 to reflect the corrected total of \$25,800.00, consistent with the private-provider fee reduction required under F.S. §553.791(2)(b) and the County's own fee ordinance;

2. Provide a written itemized breakdown of any fees the Division maintains are properly chargeable at the full standard rate, together with the basis for that determination; and
3. Confirm the revised invoice amount in writing so that payment can be remitted promptly and permit issuance is not delayed.

We appreciate the Division's attention to this matter and are prepared to provide any additional documentation needed to support prompt resolution. Please direct correspondence to permits@meridianpermits.com or (561) 555-0148.

Respectfully,

Alex Rivera

Permit Consultant, Meridian Permit Solutions, LLC